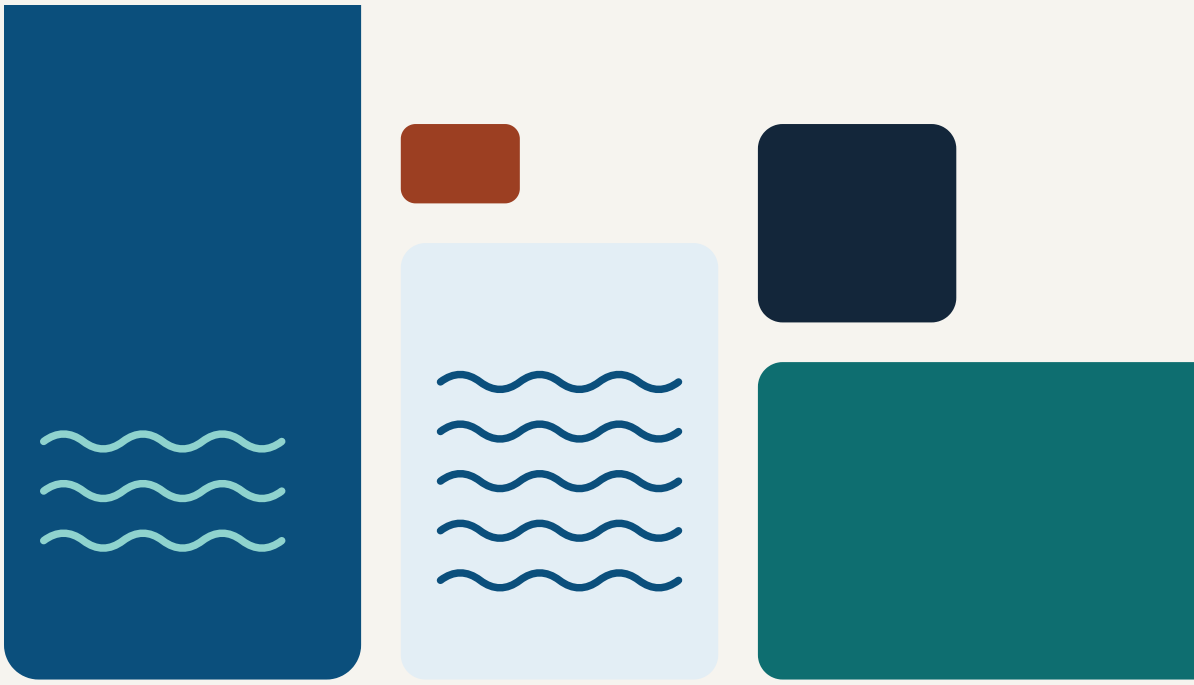
Massena.ai

Massena.ai

Brand identity guidelines

Plain facts about an AI data center in Massena.



Version 1.0 · November 2026

BRAND IDEA

The river has always powered Massena’s work.

Massena.ai is a plain-language information site for the residents of the Town of Massena, New York, about a proposed AI data center powered by St. Lawrence hydropower.

The brand’s job is trust. It should feel like a well-run public library or a good town newsletter — calm, local, evidence-first — never like a tech launch or a sales page.

The identity is built from what Massena already is: the St. Lawrence River and Seaway, the hydro dam and its piers, the bend of the Grasse River, North Country pine, downtown brick and the pale limestone shoreline.

Taglines

Pick one per surface. Don’t stack them.

Plain facts about an AI data center in Massena.

Your town. Your questions. Real answers.

Powered by the river. Explained for the neighbors.

Personality

NEIGHBORLY · PLAIN-SPOKEN · EVIDENCE-FIRST · CALM · ROOTED

LOGO

Crest and river

Massena.ai

The M is drawn as a dam crest — two piers and a spillway — sitting on two St. Lawrence waves. Massena's initial, its dam and its river in one shape. "Massena" leads in Source Serif 4; ".ai" follows in Public Sans, hydro teal.



Primary
Light grounds



Night river
Dark grounds



Single ink
Print, one color



White
Photos, dark fills

Clear space

One quarter of the mark's width on every side. Minimum size 24px / 0.25 in.

Don't

Recolor, rotate, outline or add effects. Change the wordmark's typeface or the color of ".ai". Place the tile on busy photos. Pair it with the Town of Massena seal.

COLOR

Seaway, river, pine and brick

Lead with Seaway blue on limestone. Left chip: Daylight theme; right chip: Night river theme. Every text pair meets WCAG 4.5:1 in both.

seaway `#0b4f7c · dark #73b8e6`
THE brand color — St. Lawrence Seaway blue. Primary buttons, links, the mark tile, key headings; as text on limestone, surface-raised and frost.

pine `#2e5b3a · dark #8cc79b`
North Country forest green — environment, land and community-benefit topics; as text on limestone and surface-raised. Not a success state.

ink `#13263a · dark #eef2f5`
Headlines and body copy on limestone, surface-raised, frost and notice.

limestone `#f6f4ef · dark #0d1925`
Page background — the pale limestone of the St. Lawrence shoreline (dark: night river). Default ground for every page.

river-light `#8fd3ce · dark #2b8f8b`
The wave lines in the mark and the river-lines pattern. Decorative only, never text.

hydro `#0e6e70 · dark #5cc8c2`
Secondary accent — the Grasse River and clean hydropower. Energy/water topics, data highlights; as text on limestone and surface-raised.

brick `#9c3f22 · dark #f19a75`
Downtown-Massena brick. Warmth and warnings: trade-offs, things to watch, deadlines. Always paired with a label or icon; as text on limestone and surface-raised.

ink-muted `#4a5866 · dark #a9b7c4`
Captions, source lines, dates and metadata on limestone, surface-raised and frost.

frost `#e3eef5 · dark #123552`
Tinted sections and quiet highlights; seaway text and ink both read on it.

notice `#f4ead0 · dark #2e2615`
Background of the disclosure banner and 'what we don't know yet' callouts; ink text on it.

TOPIC	COLOR
Power & energy	hydro
Jobs, economy, taxes, schools	seaway
Land, water & environment	pine
Trade-offs, things to watch	brick

TYPOGRAPHY

A newspaper of record, set for neighbors

Aa

Source Serif 4

Headlines, figures and the wordmark. Weight 600. The voice of a trusted local paper.

Aa

Public Sans

Everything else. Designed by the U.S. government for public information. Body runs at 17px for a broad, older readership — never smaller for running copy.

display · 56px/60px · 600

What an AI data center means for Massena

h1 · 40px/46px · 600

Jobs and the local tax base

h2 · 28px/34px · 600

Where the power comes from

stat · 48px/52px · 600

1802

h3 · 20px/28px · 600

Will my electric bill change?

body · 17px/27px · 400

The project would draw on hydropower already generated on the St. Lawrence.

small · 14px/20px · 400

Source: NYS historic marker, Route 37

label · 13px/16px · 600

ENERGY · WATER · JOBS

SHAPES & IMAGERY

Three local motifs

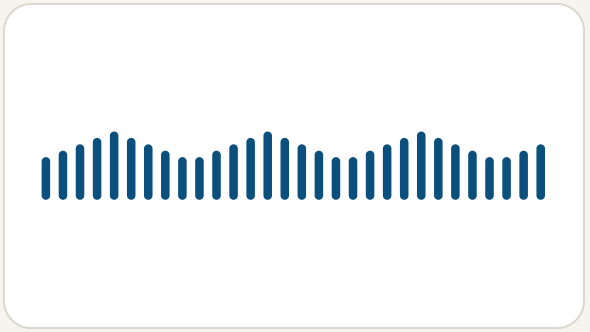


The crest

The M of the mark: two piers and a spillway. Used only as the logo.

River lines

Soft St. Lawrence waves at low opacity behind heroes and section breaks.



Pier rhythm

Rounded bars rising and falling like dam piers from the shore. Dividers and footers — never data.

Corners & space

Soft, not bubbly: 10px for buttons and cards, 14px for feature panels (echoing the mark tile), pills only for topic tags. 4px base grid; 48px between sections. Generous white space reads as calm and honest.

Imagery

Real photographs of Massena — the river, the dam, the locks, Main Street, people at work — in daylight and natural color. No glowing server rooms, robots or brains. Label any rendering “Artist’s rendering”.

VOICE

Trust is earned in the copy first

- **Neighbor voice.** Second person, short sentences, grade-8 reading level.
- **Every number has a source** — document and date, right under it.
- **Show the trade-offs.** Each benefit page carries a “Things to watch” section: water, noise, construction traffic, rates, job duration.
- **Say what isn’t known yet** instead of guessing.
- **Disclose who runs the site** on every page. Never imply it is the Town’s official website.
- **Questions as headings:** “Will my electric bill change?”
- **Sentence case.** No hype words, exclamation marks, emoji or urgency.

DO

Where will the power come from?

The project would buy electricity from the existing grid in the Massena area, which is fed by hydropower generated on the St. Lawrence.

Source: [document, date]

DON’T

Massena is about to power the AI revolution!

Hype, no source, no trade-off.

COMPONENTS

Built for clarity

Buttons

Ask a question

Read the full report

See the sources

One primary per view. Verb first, sentence case. 3px focus ring on every control.

Disclosure

Who runs this site. Massena.ai is published by [project sponsor] to explain the proposed data center. It is not an official Town of Massena website. About us and our sources

Required in every footer and at the top of the About page.

OUR TOWN

1802

The year Massena was formed — one of St. Lawrence County's first ten towns.

Source: NYS historic marker; St. Lawrence County Historical Association

THINGS TO WATCH

Construction traffic. Trucks on local roads during the build, and how routes would be managed.

Source: to be added from the project's traffic study